2022

Government of the Republic of Malawi

SOCIAL SUPPORT FOR RESILIENT LIVELIHOODS PROJECT

STAKEHOLDER ENGAGEMENT PLAN

– UPDATED FOR SECOND ADDITIONAL FINANCING -

OCTOBER 2022

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LIST OF ACRONYMS

ADC	:	Area Development Committee
AF1	:	First Additional Financing
AF2	:	Second Additional Financing
CMC	:	Catchment Management Committee
COMSIP	:	Community Savings and Investment Promotion
DESC	:	District Environmental Sub-Committee
DSSC	:	District Social Support Committee
DTT	:	District Training Team
EAD	:	Environmental Affairs Department
EPWP	:	Enhanced Public Works Programme
MoA	:	Ministry of Agriculture
MGCDSW	:	Ministry of Gender, Community Development and Social Welfare
MFEEA	:	Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs
MLYMD	:	Ministry of Labour Youth and Manpower Development
MNREM	:	Ministry of Natural Resources energy and Mining
MASAF	:	Malawi Social Action Fund
SSRLP	:	Malawi Social Support for Resilient Livelihoods Project
SSRLP AF	;	Social Support for Resilient livelihoods Project Additional Financing
NGO	:	Non-Governmental Organisation
NLGFC	:	National Local Government Finance Committee
SCTP	:	Social Cash Transfer Program
UBR	:	Unified Beneficiary Register
VDC	:	Village Development Committee

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background and Context

Inclusivity and resilience are key themes embedded in Malawi's long term development vision of being an inclusively wealthy and self-reliant nation. Under the MW2063 agenda, safety nets are particularly considered as a key contributor to the human capital development enabler of the vision. The country has resolved to promote inclusiveness in its human capital development by fostering gender transformative approaches, ensuring shared prosperity by providing marginalized and vulnerable groups with improved safety nets which have effective delivery mechanisms.

In recent years, Malawi has faced the highest sensitivity to extreme weather events mainly due to its inherent geographical and adaptive capacity vulnerabilities. In this context, safety nets are increasingly recognized as playing a critical role to promote resilience and long-term development in the economy. In Malawi, safety net programs have a track record of effectively targeting the poorest households with income support to smoothen consumption and enhance household-level human capital investments. This positive feature emerges strongly when compared especially against other priority poverty and relief response mechanisms.

The Government of Malawi has implemented two generations of national social support programs (NSSPs). The current program, the MNSSPII (2018-2023) is anchored upon three mutually supporting pillars namely consumption support, resilient livelihoods, and shock sensitive social protection. It is around this framework that the design of the Social Support for Resilient Livelihoods Project (SSRLP) was built, reflecting strong government ownership.

1.2 Purpose of Stakeholder Engagement

SSRLP is a multifaceted project which involves different individuals, groups and institutions who are expected to play key roles at national, district and community levels to achieve the objectives of the project. In achieving the goals of the project there may also be stakeholders whose interests may be affected by the activities of the project either positively or negatively. A clear understanding of the nature, interest and concerns of such role players will be crucial for effective design and delivery of project interventions.

The purpose of the SEP is to present a strategy for engaging stakeholders of the project to ensure that they understand the project and are able to provide feedback and input into the project. It also describes the nature of anticipated stakeholders as well as their information requirements, timing and methods of engagement throughout the lifecycle of the SSRL project.

2. PROJECT DESCRIPTION

The Social Support for Resilient Livelihoods Project is a project which was initiated by the Government of Malawi with an initial US$142 million grant from the World Bank. The SSRLP is for five (5) years and runs from 2020 to 2025. Development Objective of SSRLP is to improve resilience among the poor and vulnerable populations and strengthen the national platform for safety nets.

2.1 Main components of SSRLP

The SSRLP has three main components:

(1) Improving Social and Economic Inclusion: The Improving Social and Economic Inclusion component will have two subcomponents:
(a) Enhanced Core Programs and (b) Financing Scalable Safety Nets. The Enhanced Core Programs subcomponent will focus on the consolidation of an appropriate package of support for beneficiary households with a mix of program interventions, including social cash transfers (SCT), livelihoods support, and enhanced public works (EPW) as well as an option for scalable financing in times of crisis.

(2) Strengthening Harmonized Delivery Systems: Under strengthening harmonized delivery systems component, the project will establish systems that will promote harmonization within the social safety net sector and potentially link to other sectors to improve effectiveness of delivery. Such systems will include an institutionalized national social registry (Unified Beneficiary Registry), electronic payment and citizen's engagement and social accountability including grievance redress

(3) Capacity Building and Institutional Strengthening Support: The capacity building and institutional strengthening support component will support the enactment of the MNSSP II, the setting up of the necessary institutional structure for its implementation, as well as the general management and evaluation of the SSRLP.

2.2 First additional financing

The Government of Malawi applied for First Additional Financing (AF1) from the International Development Association to cover the financing gap as well as scale up coverage of core components of the Social Support for Resilient Livelihoods Project (SSRLP. Project Development Objective of SSRLP Additional Financing remains "to improve resilience among the poor and vulnerable populations and strengthen the national platform for safety nets". The indicative budget for the additional financing is US$175 million and these resources are expected to be utilized from 2022 to 2025.

2.2.1 Areas of focus for the first additional financing (AF1)

The specific objectives, areas of focus, and breakdown of resource allocations for the SSRLP First Additional Financing are as follows:

(1) Covering the existing financing gap in SCTP: The AF is expected to fully cover the gap in *Subcomponent 1.1: Enhanced Core Programs,* and specifically in its activity *1.1.1: Social Cash Transfer Program.* This activity originally received US$59 million equivalent from the IDA grant, had a US$41 million original gap plus another US$10.5

million spent for Covid 19 Urban Cash Intervention (CUCI) that was not included in the original project design. This gap was recently reassessed by GoM to be US$34.5 million, which is the amount needed to cover the SCTP in 11 districts covered by the World Bank until the project closing. Therefore, US$35 million from the AF has been earmarked for the SCTP to fill the program's financing gap in full.

(2) Scaling up EPWP to mitigate the risk of ex-AIP beneficiaries falling into deeper poverty: This is to address the risk of transitioning Affordable Input Program (AIP) beneficiaries falling into even deeper poverty. Thus the Enhanced Public Works Program/ Climate Smart Public Works Program (EPWP/CSPWP) is expected to be expanded over the 35,000 beneficiaries covered by the original financing to ensure comprehensive and efficient social safety net packages for different profiles of poor beneficiaries, and to establish pathways to graduation. The EPWP, which currently has US$20 million allocated under the original IDA, will be topped up with another US$108 million. During the predecessor MASAF IV project the regular public works intervention was drastically reduced and then discontinued until an enhanced program was designed, piloted and evaluated. Under the AF, the EPWP will reach out to ~~.~~400,000 beneficiaries who will work for 6 months per year for two years in all the 28 district councils. These would be households transitioning from the AIP. For comparison, it should be noted that the traditional MASAF IV public works program used to reach regularly around 450,000 beneficiaries per operational cycle, and at times of emergencies this number surpassed 900,000. In terms of design of the EPWP, the Government of Malawi will continue with the Catchment Management approach where focus of the public works is on catchment rehabilitation and restoration activities such as afforestation, forest regeneration, soil and water conservation technologies, river bank protection ~~–~~and disaster risk reduction measures.

(3) Scaling up Livelihoods Support to ensure success of the SCTP and EPWP and provide a path to graduation: The Livelihoods Support would be allocated US$13 million from the AF to allow the inclusion of more of the SCTP and EPWP beneficiaries in graduation and skills programs. This program has proven very effective in providing a sustainable pathway out of poverty for the beneficiaries of the other core programs. It is a necessary element of the effectiveness of the core programs package.

(4) Increasing the IDA allocation for the Scalable Social Safety Nets subcomponent: The Scalable Social Safety Nets will receive an additional US$10 million from the AF. This will expand the coverage from the scalable mechanism from three to six districts for the next two agricultural seasons. The additional funding will be used to increase the contingent financing instrument, complimenting the US$10 million premium financing provided by GRIF, which will be procured across all six districts under scalable safety nets. Adding additional resources to the contingent finance instrument will allow flexibility to respond to shocks that don't meet the insurance payout trigger.

(5) Ensuring proper systems building and project management: Finally, US$5 million will be allocated to *Component 2: Strengthening Harmonized Delivery Systems*, to expand the use of e-payments for all core safety nets activities table; and US$4 million will be added for capacity building, project management, and operational costs for the expanded core programs

Table 1: Summary allocation of the AF by components/activity

Component Subcomponent Activity	**Original amount (IDA/RETF)**	**AF amount (IDA) (400,000 EPWP beneficiaries working 6 months per year)**	**Purpose**
Subcomponent 1.1: Enhanced Core Programs, activity 1.1.1: **Social Cash Transfer Program (SCTP)**	**US$59 million** equivalent IDA grant and US$41 million financing gap	**US$35.0 million** equivalent IDA grant/credit	**Filling in a financing gap** Details: 147,000 beneficiaries in 11 districts receiving social cash transfer payments for the whole duration of the project
Subcomponent 1.1: Enhanced Core Programs, activity 1.1.2: **Enhanced Climate Smart Public Works Program (EPWP)**	**US$20 million** equivalent IDA grant	**US$108.0 million** equivalent IDA grant/credit	**Scaling up** Details: 400,000 transitioning beneficiaries from the AIP, in 28 districts working for 6 months per year, for a period of 2 years
Subcomponent 1.1: Enhanced Core Programs, activity 1.1.3: **Livelihoods Support (Social and Economic Inclusion)**	**US$20 million** equivalent IDA grant	**US$13.0 million** equivalent IDA grant/credit	**Scaling up** Pilot Graduation program for 1000 SCTP beneficiaries; complementary livelihood support for groups of beneficiaries of SCTP and EPWP.
Subcomponent 1.2: **Financing Scalable Safety Nets**	**US$27 million** equivalent of which US$10 million equivalent IDA grant and US$17 million GRiF Trust Fund	**US$10.0 million** equivalent IDA grant/credit	**Scaling up** Increasing the available financing to cover additional beneficiaries in three new districts
Component 2: **Strengthening Harmonized Delivery Systems, Subcomponent**	**US$11** million equivalent IDA grant	**US$5.0 million** equivalent IDA grant/credit	**Scaling up** Migrating the payment system to e-payment for the delivery of both SCT and EPWP programs , and delivering safety nets benefits to beneficiaries for a period of 3.5 years, including targeting of scaled-up EPWP program;
Component 3: **Capacity Building and Institutional Strengthening Support**	**US$5 million** equivalent IDA grant	**US$4.0 million** equivalent IDA grant/credit	**Scaling up** Providing sufficient financing to manage expanded core programs
Component 4: **Contingent Emergency Response (CERC)**	**US$0**		
TOTAL	**US$142.0 million** (US$125.0 million IDA and US$17.0 million GRiF)	**US$175.0 million**	

2.3 Second additional financing (AF2)

The Government of Malawi has applied for Second Additional Financing (AF2) from the International Development Association to scale up coverage of core components of the Social Support for Resilient Livelihoods Project (SSRLP) in response to the emerging emergency situations. Project Development Objective of SSRLP Second Additional Financing (SSRLP AF2) remains "to improve resilience among the poor and vulnerable populations and strengthen the national platform for safety nets". The indicative budget for the additional financing is US$95 million.

2.3.1 Scope and design elements of the SSRLP AF2

- ***Leveraging existing safety net interventions to support urgent need of assistance for the poorest, hit by crises.*** The AF2 would be structured to co-finance existing components and activities of SSRLP to be agreed with the Government and with participating DPs (for the MDTF) during preparation and appraisal. The exact distribution of AF2 financing across existing activities is likely to follow proportionally the original size and coverage of the safety net programs under SSRLP. AF2 activities could therefore include some or all of the following (in line with Components 1 and 2 of the SSRLP operation and the SSRFP First Additional Financing):
  a) **SCTP:** The SCTP is a program that almost all donors fund and can serve as the 'floor' of the social protection sector. This will include cash transfers for beneficiaries in all target districts. SSRLP AF2 may finance a horizontal expansion of the SCTP program of the World Bank in the currently-supported 11 districts to cover a higher proportion of the ultra-poor population of Malawi. The current coverage of the ultra-poor is 10 percent of the population. However, the percentage of ultra-poor in Malawi is on average 15 percent or higher and AF2 can increase the coverage. AF2 can also help cover a larger percentage of ultra-poor in other districts, currently covered by other development partners. AF2 will also be supporting: (a) investments in the operational systems and procedures to ensure strong fiduciary oversight of the funds, including strengthening financial management and payment systems for predictable and accountable transfers; (b) funding for critical equipment and supporting systems; (c) operational costs; and (d) funding for staff or consultants and training.
  b) **CS-EPWP:** The CS-EPWP is a complementary social protection instrument to the SCTP, implemented nationwide. Designed around Integrated Catchment Management approach and focusing on restoring degraded watersheds or catchments by involving the poor with labour capacity. This will include wages for the CS-EPWP beneficiaries in targeted districts, and linkages with livelihoods opportunities under the graduation component of the SSRLP. Specifically, activities would be focused on: (a) investments in the operational systems and procedures to ensure strong fiduciary oversight of the funds, including strengthening financial management and payment systems for predictable and accountable transfers; (b) funding for critical inputs, materials and supporting systems; (c) operational costs; and (d) funding for staff or technical consultants and training.
  c) **Financing scalable safety nets:** financing of contingency budgets for rapid government response during a crisis according to pre-determined triggers.

d) **Livelihoods:** Continuation and scale up of livelihoods interventions under a graduation approach, which could allow poor and vulnerable households beneficiaries from EPWP and SCTP to increase their incomes and access sustainable livelihoods. Sequenced activities include provision of training and mentoring to beneficiaries, and formation of savings and loan groups, together with investments in operational systems, operational and staff costs to build and strengthen capacities.
e) Strengthening Harmonized Delivery Systems: supporting scale up and harmonization of systems improvements and system maintenance of social protection programs, particularly the SCTP, but with a view of an integrated platform to monitor interventions on the ground (unified UBR, linkages with National ID, etc.). Migrating the payment system to e-payment and strengthening of other harmonized delivery systems including the unified beneficiary registry (UBR) and case management and grievance redress systems.

Building on the satisfactory experience of implementing regular social safety nets, economic inclusion interventions and COVID-19 emergency cash transfers, AF2 resources will also support the following activities: 1) "Cash plus" programming that combines consumption support and livelihood enhancement and diversification for both rural and urban households, 2) support medium term preparedness for food insecurity in the most drought prone districts across Malawi through scaling up a flexible contingency financing mechanism that scales up emergency cash responses during droughts. These activities will be implemented in close coordination with the relevant humanitarian response structures to ensure complementarity across the broader crisis response programming.

3. LEGISLATIVE AND POLICY CONTEXT

The development of this SEP took into account the legal and policy context of the Republic of Malawi, as well as World Bank's policies and guidelines on environmental and social risks and impacts management. To begin with, the Constitution of the Republic of Malawi provides for freedoms, rights and responsibilities to the citizens of the country. Therefore, stakeholder engagement, under this project, will ensure that people's rights and freedoms are observed, promoted and protected at all times in accordance to the Constitution. Secondly, the Environmental Management Act, 2017 was enacted to ensure conservation and management of the environment in the country. It also provided for the establishment of the Malawi Environmental Protection Authority (MEPA), which regulates environmental and social protection and management in Malawi; and the need for consultation with key stakeholders in all activities related to the utilization and management of environment and natural resources. Thirdly, the land legislations of Malawi outline the governance, administration and other provisions pertaining to land matters in the country. This SEP, therefore, takes into account these provisions and requirements so that all key stakeholders and structures are properly consulted in this project. Furthermore, since the project spans across the country covering all districts and cities, and therefore, will deal with various groups of people, which triggers the social protection policies and other legislations such as the National HIV and AIDS Policy (2012), the National Gender Policy (2017), Disability Act (2012), and labour laws. Lastly, the World Bank's Environmental and Social Framework, particularly the ESS10, makes stakeholder engagement and information disclosure a requirement for projects which the Bank finances. The standard stresses that the nature and level of stakeholder engagement should be commensurate with the level of the risk and impact anticipated in the project.

4. THE STAKEHOLDER ENGAGEMENT PLAN

4.1 Introduction

It is clear that the second additional financing will not lead to introduction of new activities into the SSRLP but will just support the expansion of the existing activities within the project components. The AF2 will therefore utilize the same Stakeholder Engagement Plan which was developed for the initial and first additional financing of the SSRLP with minor updates.

4.2 Previous stakeholder engagement activities

The second additional financing for Social Support for Resilient Livelihoods Project builds on the foundation laid down by MASAF IV and the parent SSRLP interventions and as such it will benefit from the consultations that were undertaken during the preparation and implementation of the parent SSRLP and the MASAF IV. These included the national and sub-national stakeholder consultation and joint project preparation sessions as well as the ongoing interactions during project implementation.

4.3 Stakeholder Identification and Analysis

The interventions under the SSRLP are expected to reach out to approximately over 622,000[1] households with core safety net programs of social cash transfers, enhanced livelihood support packages and public works. Under AF2 about 435,000 participants are being targeted to benefit under SCT, ELSP and CS-EPWP. The design and delivery of each of these core programs will involve several supporting partners led and coordinated by the Government of Malawi through relevant ministries, departments and agencies. The social cash transfer program was seen as an anchor program for the SSRLP and therefore it was initially implemented in the 11 districts (Karonga, Rumphi, Nkhatabay, Kasungu, Nkhotakota, Ntchisi, Lilongwe, Dowa, Dedza, Blantyre and Chiradzulu) with support from the World Bank. It is now being extended to all 28 districts and 4 cities under the First Additional Financing (AF1) and Second Additional Financing (AF2).

4.4 Leverage on Existing Key Stakeholders, Structures and Institutional Arrangements

SSRLP will continue to leverage on existing decentralised implementation structures and arrangements built under MASAF IV with strong reforms. The National Local Government Finance Committee (NLGFC) is the main implementing agency for the SSRLP AF1 and AF2, working in close cooperation with several key implementing partners, including Ministry of Local Government; Ministry of Gender, Community Development and Social Welfare; Ministry of Labour; Ministry of Agriculture; Ministry of Natural Resources and Climate Change; Ministry of Lands; Community Savings and Investment Promotion Cooperative Union; and Local Authorities. Ministry of Gender, Community Development and Social Welfare, jointly with NLGFC, are implementing the SCTP which initially started in the

[1] This is an estimated working figure which includes 35,000 and 400,000 beneficiaries from the EPWP under the original and additional financing respectively; 147000 beneficiaries from SCTP and about 40,000 from Scalable Safety Nets Component.

aforementioned 11 districts and has been extended to the entire country. For the Climate Smart Enhanced Public Works Program (CS-EPWP), NLGFC will work with the existing Technical Task Force that involves several line ministries. The livelihoods and skills development activities will continue to be implemented with the participation of existing structures, including Ministry of Community Development, Culture and Civic Education, Community Savings and Investment Promotion (COMSIP), with NLGFC support. At the district level, project activities will be managed by the offices of the District Commissioners. The DCs will oversee all activities related to SCTP and CS-EPWP and will provide support to the implementation of the livelihoods and economic inclusion. At community level, the implementation process for the variety of SSRLP AF2 activities will be led by the Community Social Support Committee (CSSC) within the Village Development Committee (VDC). As stated earlier, AF2 is primarily an emergency cash transfer payment for urban and rural beneficiary households so that they can meet their immediate needs, as well as for livelihoods restorations support for farm and off farm income generating activities, and preparedness for food insecurity, which will be coordinated by relevant governmental agencies that deals with humanitarian responses.

4.5 Stakeholder Identification and Relevance

Table 2: Stakeholder Identification

Category 1: Project Sponsors/ Supporters		
	Stakeholder Name	**Relevance**
	Government of Malawi	Sourcing funding, and disbursement of funds
	World Bank	Financier
	Other Development Partners	Co-financiers of the Multi-Donor Trust Fund (MDTF)
	NGLFC	Project Coordination
	Rural and Urban Local Authorities	Project implementation
	Category 2: Project Beneficiaries	**Relevance**
	Government of Malawi	Socio-economic development, and delivery of social support and resilience building services
	Rural and Urban Local Authorities	Fulfilment of their service delivery mandates
	Targeted communities	Employment opportunities, improved livelihoods, and improved catchments, roads and other amenities.
	Participating individuals	Source of income, improved livelihoods, food security/ improved nutrition and health
	Local businesses	Opportunity for increased trade through supply of project required materials, food stuffs and other things
	Category 3: The Affected	
	Affected villages/ communities	Direct impacts of project activities
	Farm & land owners	Direct impacts e.g. potential encroachment on private property

	Vulnerable groups	Could be side-lined in consultations and other activities
	Local businesses	Could be disrupted during some project activities e.g. public works on roads
	General public/ traffic	Disruption of traffic, or other public utilities
	Category 4: Influencers	
	Stakeholder Name	**Relevance**
	Legislature	Makes laws and oversight role
	District Commissioners, and City CEOs	Overseer of development in the districts and cities
	Chiefs & Block Leaders	Gatekeepers/ entry into villages/ communities and urban areas
	Malawi Environmental Protection Agency (MEPA)	Regulates E&S, and monitors compliance of projects
	Affected communities	Cooperation with implementer(s)/ involvement/ ownership
	Farm & land owners	Cooperation with implementers
	Media	Information dissemination/ news reporting
	Local NGOs and CBOs	Enhancing accountability and advocacy on inclusiveness in project delivery

4.6 Affected Parties

In this Project, the beneficiaries and the communities who are expected to be targeted by the interventions will constitute the project affected parties. The core safety net programs of SSRLP AF2 will mostly target the members of the ultra-poor and vulnerable households in selected communities with an aim of providing consumption support and where possible some livelihood development opportunities to lift them out of poverty. There will be some slight variations within the target groups from one safety net program to another depending on the objectives of the respective program. For instance, SCTP will target the ultra-poor and labour constrained households while the enhanced public works will target the ultra-poor households with labour capacity. Livelihood interventions will target ultra-poor households who voluntarily express their interest to participate regardless of their labour capacity status. Ultra-poor households have on average 1 meal per day and/or their survival depends on begging and/or are undernourished and/or do not have valuable possessions/assets and/or receive no external help such as money, food and gifts. Labour-constrained means the household has no member between 19-64 years fit for work and/or, household has a dependency ratio of more than 3, school going members in the age bracket 19 – 25 years.

The environmental and social risks of the activities of SSRLP AF2 are generally expected to be moderate because of the nature of activities that have been incorporated in the project design. A lot of lessons from the challenges encountered in MASAF series of programs have been built in to keep the potential risks from the project as low as reasonably achievable. The main one being the proposed reduction in scale of the public works component in the project as well as reformed approach in its delivery. The vulnerable groups that are being targeted by the project interventions will however still be adequately engaged in order to ensure that their views regarding the project are taken on board for enhancement of project benefits. The nature of this

project and the level of anticipated risks project does not warrant special methods of engagement other than those that are normally used.

4.7 Other Interested Parties

Other interested interest parties include various individuals, institutions and organisations that will be directly involved in the delivery of the project from National, district to community level. At national level there will be the NLGFC as a coordinating institution and government ministries, departments and agencies (MDAs) as described under 3.0. At district level, the District Commissioners of the target districts, Members of the council, the executive committee and its sub-committees and nongovernmental organisations working in such districts will be direct interested parties. The traditional leaders, area and village development committees and their subcommittees and community volunteers constitute some of the direct interested parties at community level.

On the other hand, the Development Partners at national level, representatives of NGOs at district and community level, religious groups and their leaders and communities in areas where the project will be implemented are some of other interested parties. Table 1 highlights the various stakeholders for SSRLP AF by project component at National, District and Community Level. Table 2 provides a description of each of the key national, district and community level stakeholders including their roles and interests.

Table 1: List of SSRLP AF stakeholders at National, City, District and Community levels according to project components and subcomponents

Project Component		***Stakeholders at National, City, District and Community Levels***			
Component	Sub-component Description	National level	City/ Urban level	District level	Community level
Component 1: Improving Social and Economic Inclusion *Sub-component 1.1. Enhanced Core Programs*	*Social Cash Transfers Program (SCTP)*	- Social Support steering committee - Social Support technical committee - MFEPD - MGCDSW/SCTP - NLGFC - Development Partners (World Bank, EU, DFID, GiZ, Irish Aid, KfW, UNICEF)	City council Authorities	District Council DEC DSSC NGOs	Targeted beneficiary households and communities, ADCs, VDCs CSSCs, Traditional and religious leaders
	Enhanced Public Works (EPWP)	- MFEPD - NLGFC - MENRM - MAIWD - MLGRD - MCECCD - MLUPD - GIZ - World Bank	City council Authorities	- District Council Members - DEC - DESC	Targeted beneficiary households and communities, ADCs, VDCs CSSCs, Traditional and religious leaders
	Livelihoods Support	- COMSIP - NLGFC	City council Authorities	- District Council Members	Targeted beneficiary households and

Project Component		***Stakeholders at National, City, District and Community Levels***			
		- National Savings and Loans Group Technical Working Group - MLYMD		- DEC - DESC DCDO and CDAs COMSIP facilitators (Nutrition and ESS promoters), aggregators and book keepers	communities, ADCs, DCs CSSCs, Traditional and religious leaders,
Sub-component 1.2. Financing Scalable Safety Nets	*Financing Scalable Safety Nets*	- MFEPD - DoDMA - MGCDSW/SCTP - NLGFC - Development Partners (World Bank, EU, DFID, GiZ, Irish Aid, KfW, UNICEF)	City council Authorities	-District Council Members - DEC - DSSC - DESC	Targeted beneficiary households and communities, ADCs, DCs CSSCs, Traditional and religious leaders
Component 2: Strengthening Harmonized Delivery Systems	*Sub-component 2.1. Social Registry*	- NLGFC - MGCDSW/SCTP - MoFEA - UBR Team - NRB	City council Authorities	District Council Members - DEC - DSSC - DESC - NRB	Targeted beneficiary households and communities, ADCs, DCs CSSCs, Traditional and religious leaders
	Sub-component 2.2. E-payments	- NLGFC - MoFEA - Service Providers (including commercial banks, security and logistics firms, mobile money networks) - Development Partners	City council Authorities	District Council Members - DEC - DSSC - DESC - service provider reps	Targeted beneficiary households and communities, ADCs, DCs CSSCs, Traditional and religious leaders
	Sub-component 2.3. Citizens' Engagement	- NLGFC - MGCDSW - Media houses - Development partners - Civil Society organisations	City council Authorities	District Council Members - DEC - DSSC - DESC - DGRM committees	Targeted beneficiary households and communities, ADCs, DCs CSSCs, Traditional and religious leaders
Component 3: Capacity Building and Institutional Strengthening Support	*Capacity Building and Institutional Strengthening Support*	- NLGFC - Government MDAs - Training institutions (local and international) - Development partners	City council Authorities	- DEC - DSSC - DESC -DGRM Committees	Targeted beneficiary households and communities, ADCs, DCs CSSCs, Traditional and religious leaders

Table 2: Description of Stakeholders and their roles, interests and needs

	Description of Stakeholder	Expected Role	Information needs and interests
A.	*Community Level*		
1	**Targeted Project Beneficiaries** - These will be ultra-poor and vulnerable households identified through the UBR and open community validation process	Contribute to the design of the project in order to maximize the benefits from the project interventions	Information on program adjustments, Payment schedules, Contact details of program focal persons, program enrolment figures
2	**Members of Project target communities** - These will be members of the communities from which beneficiaries of the -project will be identified	Support the development and implementation of the project	Information on program adjustments, Payment schedules, Contact details of program focal persons, program enrolment figures
3	**Local leaders** - These may be traditional, religious or political leaders (including ward councillors and Members of parliament) who have influence in the communities where the project will be implemented	Support implementation of programs	Involvement in program implementation
4	**Development committee members** - These are members of Area Development Committees (ADCS) which are operational at traditional Authority (TA) level and Village Development Committees (VDCs) which are operational at Group Village Head level. This also includes members of the various relevant sub-committees of the VDC which are operational at this level.	Support the development and implementation of the project	Project implementation work plans and progress reports
5	**Community Extension Workers** - These are staff of government departments and agencies who work directly with communities and act as a link with district officials involved in the project. These include community development Assistants (CDAs), Health Surveillance Assistants (HSAs), Agricultural Extension Development Officers (AEDOs), Forestry Assistants (FAs), and COMSIP volunteers.	Facilitate delivery of project interventions to communities	Project implementation work plans and progress reports
B.	*District Level*		
1	**District Council and Its subcommittees** - This is a political arm of government at district level and is constituted by elected councillors and members of parliament from the district. It also includes Traditional Authorities who however do not have do not have voting rights. The Council is chaired by Chairperson elected from among the councillors. The District Commissioner serves as secretary to the council.	It's a decision making body on all development matters taking place in the districts	Project implementation work plans and progress reports

2	**The District Executive Committee and its Sub-committees** - This is the technical arm of the government at district level and is comprised of heads government departments, Representatives of NGOs and service providers working in the district, and representatives of interest groups. It is chaired by the district commissioner. The committee has several thematic sub-committees focusing on areas such as agriculture, health, environmental and natural resources, monitoring and evaluation, education, training and capacity building and social support.	Provide technical guidance on all development matters taking place in the district	Project implementation work plans and progress reports
C.	*City Level*		
	City Council Members - Elected members of the council responsible for making policies and decisions on issues affecting their cities	Making policies and decisions on issues affecting their cities	Project implementation work plans and progress reports
	City Council Secretariat - Technical team of the council responsible for developing and implementing development programs	Actual delivery of the project activities	Project implementation work plans and progress reports
	Block Leaders - Appointed leaders of locations and neighbor hoods in the cities	Support community mobilisation and program delivery	Project information and updates
D.	*National Level*		
D1	*National Level Committees*		
1	**Social Support steering committee** - Chaired by the Chief Secretary	Policy oversight	Program updates and challenges requiring attention
2	**Social Support technical committee** - Chaired by Permanent secretary for EP&D	Direction, guidance on implementation	Program updates and challenges requiring attention
3	**National Savings and Loans Group Technical Working Group** -		Program updates and challenges requiring attention
4	**Parliamentary Committee on social support** - Committee of parliament comprising of elected members of parliament	Inform, guide and lobby the National Assembly on national policies, legislation and development projects related to the social support sector	Program updates and challenges requiring attention
C2	*Government Ministries Departments and Agencies*		
1	**National Local Government Finance Committee (NLGFC)** - NLGFC is a funding agency of the Malawi Government through which funding for development projects and other recurrent transactions to district councils is channelled and managed.	Implementing agent -manage MIS -Develop implementation and training materials -Oversee implementation	District reports and requirements
2	**Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs**	-Coordinator of the Social Protection programs	Financial information from the project
3	**Ministry of Gender, Social Welfare and Community Development** - This is the implementation coordination ministry of the social cash transfer program	Coordinate implementation of SCTP, Manage MIS for SCTP, develop	Implementation reports Community mobilisation

	Carries the Department of Community Development which is a key player on community sensitization and mobilization through their District Community Development Officers Community Development Assistants	implementation materials and Oversee implementation Community sensitization and mobilisation for project implementation of community development projects	reports and challenges for action
5	- **Ministry of Local Government** This ministry is in charge of decentralized institutions and functions that are part of the local government set up at district and community level.	Provide guidance on local governance issues affecting the project	Project updates and challenges requiring action
6	**Ministry of Natural Resources and Climate Change** - Hosts the Environmental affairs Department which has a regulatory mandate on Management of environmental and social issues associated with Projects	Support planning, implementation and monitoring of environmental and social safeguards in the project	Information on Safeguards
7	- **Ministry of Agriculture**Ministry responsible promotion and management of agricultural related activities	Provide policy and technical guidance on agricultural related livelihood activities envisaged in the project	Program implementation updates
8	**Ministry of Labour**	Provide policy direction and technical guidance on project matters relating youth and Labour	Program implementation updates
C3	*Development Partners*		
1	World Bank	- Provide technical support on project design and implementation - Provide project funding	Program implementation updates
2	European Union	- Fund SCTP	Program implementation updates
3	GiZ	- Technical support to social protection	Program implementation updates
4	German Government Through KfW		
5	Irish Aid	- Fund SCTP - Technical support to social protection	Program implementation updates
6	UNICEF	- Technical support to social protection	Program implementation updates
7	ILO	- Technical support to social protection	Program implementation updates
C4	*Non-Governmental Organisations and other Community Based Organisations*	-	
1	Community Savings and Investment Promotion (COMSIP) - Is an institution that was formed from within the MASAF series of projects as a concept aimed at	- lead the implementation of the livelihood	Program implementation updates

	promoting community development through mindset change, investment culture and asset creation by community based groups	support program of the project	
2	Concern Worldwide	- Share experiences on implementation of graduation models	Program implementation updates
3	Save the Children	- Share experiences on implementation of e-payment systems	Program implementation updates
4	United Purpose	- Share experiences on implementation of cash plus interventions	Program implementation updates
5	Citizen Engagement, Human rights advocacy and Social Accountability CSOs such as NICE, CCJP, CHRR etc	- Support citizen engagement and social accountability initiatives	Collaboration and program information updates
6	Community and Faith Based Organisations	- Support citizen engagement and social accountability initiatives	Collaboration and program information updates

4.8 Disadvantaged and Vulnerable Individuals or Groups

Much as the project is largely expected to have positive impact among beneficiary members of the target communities, there is still a possibility of individuals, families and communities that might be negatively affected by activities of the program. These may come from among the beneficiaries or non-beneficiary members of the target communities. The women and children, the youth, elderly, disabled and chronically ill are often times the most vulnerable because of their limited access to information due to physical, social, cultural and structural barriers within the communities. These categories of people will be particularly targeted with adequate information to understand the nature of project activities and anticipated positive and potential negative impacts of the project. They will also be provided with information on how to access the grievance redress mechanism of the project whenever the need arises.

Members of the community that are old might have mobility challenges to access venues for program activities such as meetings. There will be consideration to organize meetings within manageable distances for such people. Another envisaged challenge is high illiteracy levels in some of the target communities that will make it difficult for beneficiaries to read and understand written information pertaining to the project. Appropriate methods such as public meetings, visual media (posters, billboards, community videos), will be employed to reach out to such groups of people. Hearing challenges (due to age or birth) by some beneficiaries might require use of sign language aides in outreach and visibility tools as well as Public Address systems or megaphones, especially where the meetings attract large crowds of people.
Extra effort will be undertaken to reach out to non-beneficiating members of the target communities in order to make them understand the project targeting processes and capacity limits so that they do not feel disadvantaged.

5. STAKEHOLDER ENGAGEMENT PROGRAM

5.1 Purpose and Timing of Stakeholder Engagement Program

The purpose of the engagement program for this project is to:

a. Consult stakeholders on the proposed project design, anticipated environmental and social risks and impacts, mitigation measures, the draft engagement plan and the draft environmental and social risk management instruments.

b. Provide regular information and feedback to stakeholders related to project implementation progress and any other emerging issues throughout the project cycle.

Table 3: Stakeholder Engagement Program

No.	Project Phase	Engagement Activity	Objective	Targeted Stakeholders	Time Frame
1	Project Preparation Phase	National stakeholder consultations City level	Collect views on the design of the project, environmental and social risks, mitigation measures, grievance redress mechanisms and Stakeholder engagement plan	Representatives of Government MDAS, Development Partners, and NGOs	April 2019
		Local Authority level Stakeholder consultations	Collect views on the design of the project, environmental and social risks, mitigation measures, grievance redress mechanisms and Stakeholder engagement plan	Members of the District/City Executive Committees and its Subcommittees	April 2019
		Community level Stakeholder consultations	Collect views on the design of the project, environmental and social risks, mitigation measures, grievance redress mechanisms and Stakeholder engagement plan	Members of ADCs, VDCs, CSSCs, COMSIP groups, Traditional and religious Leaders, AECs, Ordinary members of the community including women, youths, the elderly and disabled	April 2019
2	Project Implementation Phase	Project inception meetings with District Councils	Provide feedback on approved project design and orient district level stakeholders on their roles	Members of the District Executive Committees	January 2020
		Community mobilization	Mobilize and prepare target communities for project implementation	Members of target communities, ADCs, VDCs, traditional, religious and political leaders, development sub-committees such as CSSCs, COMSIP	February 2020

No.	Project Phase	Engagement Activity	Objective	Targeted Stakeholders	Time Frame
				groups and marginalized groups	
		Project implementation monitoring and supervision missions	Provide and obtain on going information and support on project performance	National, district, and community level stakeholders	Ongoing at least on quarterly basis through out
		Project review meetings with selected stakeholders from National, District and Community level	Provide and get periodic feedback on project implementation progress and any emerging issues	Selected National, District and Community level stakeholders	Twice a year from December 2020 to December 2025
3	Project Close Out Phase	Project close out meetings	Engage stakeholders on project exit strategy	Beneficiary communities and groups, national and district stakeholders	2025

5.2 Proposed Strategy for Information Disclosure

Appropriate information will be provided to stakeholders depending on the stage of the project and the identified stakeholder information needs. This will include information on the nature of the project design, the anticipated environmental and social risks and impacts, the proposed mitigation measures, the stakeholder engagement plan, grievance redress mechanisms and how stakeholder views were incorporated in the project design and management of environmental and social risks.

The Project will use a combination of methods to disclose information pertaining to the project in a manner that is commensurate with the nature of the identified stakeholders and environmental and social sensitivity of the project. For community level stakeholders, information will mostly be disclosed through public meetings organized within the communities. Deliberate efforts will be made to ensure that vulnerable groups of people such as women and children, the elderly and disabled are adequately represented and heard in such meetings. At national and district level, disclosure of information will be done through meetings with the representatives and members of relevant MDAs, committees and sub-committees. Printed and electronic copies of relevant project documents will be made available to stakeholders through appropriately designated places within reach of stakeholders.

Communication to stakeholders on information disclosure programmes will be conveyed through relevant means depending on targeted audiences. Mostly, the project will use written forms of communication such as letters and electronic mails, community radio stations where available, and mobile public address system. Where possible social media platforms and groups will be created assist in information dissemination to targeted stakeholders. All these processes, platforms, and channels will be linked to the NLGFC website. Table 4 summarizes the key methods that will be used for disclosure of Project information at different stages of the Project.

Table 4: Methods for Disclosure of Project Information

Project stage	List of information to be disclosed	Methods proposed	Timetable: Locations/ dates	Target stakeholders	Percentage reached	Responsibilities
Project Preparation	Project Design summary, Stakeholder Engagement Plan, Environmental and Social Commitment Plan, Grievance Redress Mechanism setup	Community Meetings, Events, and gatherings	Selected communities, April–September 2019 and After Bank Approval	Members of target communities in target districts	About 40% percent of target audience	NLGFC in Collaboration with District Councils
		Community and National Radio stations Billboards, banners, leaflets,	After Bank Approval	Community members in target districts	60% of target audience	Project preparation team members
		Make available printed and electronic copies at National, and District level focal offices as well as online portals	April–September 2019 and After Bank Approval	National and District level stake holders	95 % of target stakeholders	NLGFC
Project implementation	Project Progress Reports	Review Meetings Community radios, national radios, billboards, banners, newspaper placements, freebies etc	Annually throughout the project life span	Stakeholder representative at national, district and community level	100 % of target stakeholders	NLGFC

5.3 Proposed Strategy for Consultation

The Project will mostly employ interviews, focus group discussions, open meetings, and workshops as a means of carrying out consultations. These will be done right in the target districts and communities to enable easy participation of vulnerable and disadvantaged groups of people. Table 5 summarises the key consultations that will be undertaken.

Table 5: Summary of Key Consultations and Methods to be used

Project stage	Topic of consultation	Method used	Timetable: Location and dates	Target stakeholders	Responsibilities
Project Preparation	Project design elements	Workshop with target stakeholders	Kumbali Lodge, 24 March -2nd April, 2019	Representatives of Government MDAS, Development Partners, and NGOs	Malawi Government Project Preparation Team and World Bank Project preparation team
	Project design, Environmental and Social Risks, Mitigation Measures, GRM and Stakeholder Engagement Plan	Meetings with District Social Support Committees and District/City Environmental Sub-Committees	Six District Councils (two from each region) from 22nd to 26th April, 2019	Members of DSSC,	NLGFC in collaboration with Safeguards Task team
	Project design, Environmental and Social Risks, Mitigation Measures, GRM and Stakeholder Engagement Plan	Community Meetings and focus group discussions	Selected communities in six project target Districts Councils (two from each region) from 22nd to 26th April, 2019	Representative Members of ADC, VDC, CSSC, GRMCs, VNRMCs, COMSIP Groups, Disabled people, SCTP and PWP beneficiaries, religious leaders, political leaders,	NLGFC in collaboration with Safeguards Task team
Project Implementation	Project implementation Progress Review meetings	Community Meetings Media Bi-annually, including quarterly media tours	Project target communities, Quarterly throughout project life span	Representative Members of ADC/Ward Development Committee (WDC), VDC, CSSC, CMCs, GRMCs, VNRMCs, COMSIP Groups, Disabled people, SCTP and PWP beneficiaries, religious leaders, political leaders,	District and Urban Councils with support from central level stakeholders
Project phase out	Exit strategy preparation	Community Meetings	Project target communities, Final year of the project	Representative Members of ADC, VDC, CSSC, GRMCs, VNRMCs, COMSIP Groups, Disabled people, SCTP and PWP beneficiaries, religious leaders, political leaders,	District/City councils with support of National Project coordination team

5.4 Proposed Strategy to Incorporate the View of Vulnerable Groups

Appropriate and clear methods of communication will be used to inform in a timely manner, all participants about the meetings. This will include invitation letters where possible, stipulating the type and number of community stakeholder groups expected to come to the

meetings. Where possible and necessary, separate consultations will be done with select interest groups during community meetings. The community meetings will be properly facilitated using a pre-designed discussion guide which will carry specific questions targeting vulnerable groups. Well experienced moderators will be used to conduct community meetings to ensure equitable participation and contribution of marginalized groups. The facilitating teams will have skilled note takers who will record the deliberations verbatim with the aid of voice recorders. Consent (verbal) or and otherwise, will be sought from meeting participants before recorders are used in recording of proceedings. After completion of consultations, the field notes and transcriptions will be consolidated, analysed and key issues incorporated into the relevant project documents.

5.5 Timelines

Table 6: SSRLP Project Phase Timeline

Activity	Project Preparation	Bank Appraisal	Bank Decision	Project Implementation Preparation	Project Implementation	Project Phase out
Timeline	September 2021- December 2021	February 2022 - March, 2022	May 2022	July 2022 - Oct 2022	November 2022	2025

5.6 Summary of Stakeholder engagements to date

As already mentioned before, the SSRLP AF stands to benefit from the stakeholder engagement experiences from the parent SSRLP and the EPWP under the MASAF IV. To date a number of opportunities have been utilised for engagement with stakeholders at national, district and community level.

National level stakeholders have largely been engaged through annual program reviews, planning and budgeting sessions undertaken at least once every year. Through the reviews key stakeholders were being brought together to share experiences and feedback for improvement of program delivery. Furthermore, several program coordination meetings were being arranged as and when required by specific programs within the project such as SCT, CS-EPWP, E-Payment, Livelihoods, and CUCI to discuss and review program related issues. The implementation support missions undertaken since the effectiveness of the SSRLP also helped to provide additional platforms for periodic engagement with key central level stakeholders.

The annual program reviews, planning and budgeting sessions did not only serve national level stakeholders. They also facilitated engagement with district level stakeholders who were made to be part of the sessions and brought valuable feedback from the ground in their respective localities. Periodic program monitoring and supervision exercises undertaken to the local authorities also availed opportunities for further engagement with district level stakeholders.

Case management visits and field level monitoring and supervision visits to communities, for example, during pay parades provided direct interaction and instant feedback collection and provision opportunities with community level stakeholders including beneficiaries. Such mechanism have proven effective as they ensure direct and speedy delivery of feedback to influential entities key policy holders at national level. For instance, current considerations for possible upward adjustment of transfer levels for CS-EPWP in the AF1 and AF2 as a result of such direct interactions with beneficiaries who could raise their concerns and feedback directly to policy holders. This is in addition to those concerns channelled through the formal GRM structures.

5.7 Review of Comments

Upon disclosure of project information, provision will be made for secure portals where the general public and concerned stakeholders may submit their comments, observations and questions regarding the project. Considering the moderate degree of environmental and social risks that are anticipated in this project, these will mostly constitute lockable boxes where written comments regarding the project will be deposited. For information disclosed through meetings, instant feedback will be collected through designated rapporteurs who will be available during the meetings. Participating stakeholders will also be given freedom to take their own minutes of the proceedings and share a copy with the rapporteurs. Comment boxes will also be placed in designated places within the communities for use by community members to submit views and reactions after information disclosure meetings. After the deadline for submission is passed comment boxes will be collected from the sites for consolidation, analysis and inclusion into the project documents. A summary of how comments were taken into account will be made and shared with the stakeholders through project implementation inception meetings once the final decision on the project is made by the Bank.

5.8 Future Phases of Project

This stakeholder engagement plan has established a continuous stakeholder engagement program for the project to ensure that stakeholders are kept informed throughout the project phases. The stakeholder engagement program includes annual project review meetings, quarterly community interface meetings, and regular project monitoring and supervision visits. These platforms will provide avenues for exchange of information between project implementers and other stakeholders regarding the progress of the project and issues related to management of environmental and social risks including the grievance redress mechanism.

6. RESOURCES AND RESPONSIBILITIES FOR IMPLEMENTING STAKEHOLDER ENGAGEMENT ACTIVITIES

6.1 Resources

The Project has allocated an indicative amount of funds amounting to US$1 Million (about MK1.2 billion) to facilitate citizen engagement activities including stakeholder engagement and grievance redress mechanism for the entire project period of five years. Table 7 provides estimated budget for key stake holder engagement activities.

Table 7: Budget Estimate for Stakeholder Engagement Activities

No.	Project Phase	Engagement Activity	Objective	Targeted Stakeholders	Budget (MK)
1	Project Implementation Phase	Project inception meetings with District & City Councils	Provide feedback on approved project design and orient district level stakeholders on their roles	Members of the District & City Executive Committees	46,500,000
		Community mobilization	Mobilize and prepare target communities for project implementation	Members of target communities, ADCs, VDCs, traditional, religious and political leaders, development sub-committees such as CSSCs, COMSIP groups and marginalized groups	70,000,000
		Roll out and Manage the Grievance Redress Mechanism	Provide a systematic way of receiving, recording and resolving grievances from Project Affected Persons (PAPs)	Project Affected People at community, District, City and National levels	400,000,000.
		Project implementation monitoring and supervision missions	Provide and obtain on going information and support on project performance	National, city, district, and community level stakeholders	135,700,000
		Project review meetings with selected stakeholders from National, District and Community level	Provide and get periodic feedback on project implementation progress and any emerging issues	Selected National, City, District and Community level stakeholders	85,000,000
2	Project Close Out Phase	Project close out meetings	Engage stakeholders on project exit strategy	Beneficiary communities and groups, national and district stakeholders	40,940,253
3	Project Implementation Phase	Communication and Information – visibility and documentation	Engage beneficiaries and implementers and document progress. Disseminate to achieve visibility through systematic outreach activities	Communities, district, city and national level stakeholders	100,000,000

6.2 Management Functions and Responsibilities

The Stakeholder Engagement activities will form part of the Environmental and Social Commitment Plan (ESCP). This is a tool which will commit Management to ensuring that planned activities are implemented and form part of project approval documents which will be monitored by the World Bank. The monitoring and evaluation framework for the project will also have indicators on the ESCP whose implementation progress will be tracked and reported accordingly. ESCP Implementation progress report will be periodically produced and shared with stakeholders for review, deliberation and action.

The implementation arrangement for the project is piggy backed on the decentralized government structures at District and Community level. As such, stakeholder engagement activities at community level will mostly be done by extension workers who will be supported by the district project coordinating teams comprising of representatives of relevant departments at district council level. At national level, the Implementation of the SEP will be coordinated by NLGFC in collaboration with members of the project preparation team. The project preparation team is comprised of qualified and experienced people drawn from various relevant ministries that have a stake in the PNSS project. These include the Ministry of Local Government, Ministry of Gender, Community Development and Social Welfare, Ministry of Labour, Ministry of Agriculture, Ministry of Natural Resources and Climate Change, Ministry of Lands, Community Savings and Investment Promotion Cooperative Union, and Local Authorities. The National Local Government Finance Committee will facilitate the implementation of the Stakeholder Engagement Plan. Overall management responsibility for implementing the SEP will rest with the Executive Director of the National Local Government Finance Committee.

The contact details for the Executive Director are as follows:
The Executive Director
National Local Government Finance committee
Red Cross House, Area 14
Private Bag 352,
Lilongwe 3, MALAWI
Phone: +265 1775 666
E-mail: nlgfc@nlgfc.gov.mw

7. GRIEVANCE REDRESS MECHANISM (GRM)

The SSRLP is a multifaceted project having multiple interventions which are mostly expected to have positive impacts in the target communities and the country at large. While considerable effort and forethought has been made to include safeguards in the design and implementation of the project in order to minimize and prevent potential adverse impacts from the project, there is always a possibility that interests of some individuals, groups and institutions may still be negatively affected by activities of the project. It is therefore expected that such instances may generate complaints from individuals, groups and institutions that may be affected. As such, provision of a mechanism for receiving, recording and resolving potential concerns and complaints that may arise from Project affected persons is necessary. Such a mechanism would assist to provide early remedies to grievances so as to avoid unnecessary project implementation delays and obstructions.

The Social Support for Resilient Livelihoods Project's Additional Financing (AF1 and AF2) will strengthen the Grievance Redress Mechanism that was established under MASAF IV. The Grievance Redress and Management Committees which were established at Village, Area, and District Level will be reorganized and adequately capacitated. The same will be established in urban areas and city councils in-line with operations outlined in AF2. The GRM will also be extended to the national level and be expanded to handle all types of grievances arising from implementation of all the programs under the SSRLP including work related grievances.

Typical grievances that are anticipated from the implementation of SSRLP Programs include claims and complaints about cash transfers, poor service delivery including delays, unfair treatment by program staff, lack of information, restrictions on land use, loss of property, disruption of access paths, corrupt practices, Human rights violations, child labor, gender based violence and sexual exploitation and abuse.

Legitimacy, Accessibility, Predictability, Fairness, Rights Compatibility, Transparency and Capability are the key tenets that will underpin the grievance redress mechanism[2] for the Malawi Social Support for Resilient Livelihoods Project.

7.1 Institutional Setup of the GRM for SSRLP

The GRM for the SSRLP provides for negotiation and agreement by consensus between the community and affected persons as the first avenue to resolve grievances expressed by the people affected by the project. This is because the implementation of sub projects will be community driven and resolution at the earliest point possible would make the process faster and cost effective. Thus, the process of grievance redress mechanisms will initially be handled by grievance redress committees which operate within the community settings themselves.

However, in events where some aggrieved parties are not satisfied by decisions made at village grievance redress and management committee (VGRMC) levels, the cases will be referred for review and re - consideration to higher level grievance redress committees at Area (Traditional Authority)/Ward (AGRMC), District/City (GRMC) Levels. In cases where the grievances are not resolved at district level, the case will be referred to national level grievance redress and

[2] World Bank. 2014. The World Bank's Approach to Grievance Redress in Projects. Washington, DC. © World Bank. https://openknowledge.worldbank.org/handle/10986/20119 License: CC BY 3.0 IGO.

management committee (NGRMC). In the unlikely case that issues are not resolved at the national level the case will be referred to Court.

The GRM for the SSRLP is complimentary to other existing traditional grievance redress mechanisms within the communities and the country at large. Such existing mechanisms include traditional chiefs, Courts, Police, Anti -Corruption Bureau, Human Rights bodies and Civil Society Organizations. As such communities shall be informed about the other existing mechanisms and be allowed to make use of them when and where ever they find it necessary. This would also assist in creating alternative space for PAPs who would otherwise not be able to voice out their concerns through the main GRM structure for fear of reprisals despite repeated assurances of protection. The Project will therefore also identify and engage institutions that provide alternative grievance redress mechanism services in project target areas in order to create linkages that would provide necessary feedback to the Project GRM. Figure 1 is a schematic diagram of grievance redress mechanism institutional set up from village level up to national level.

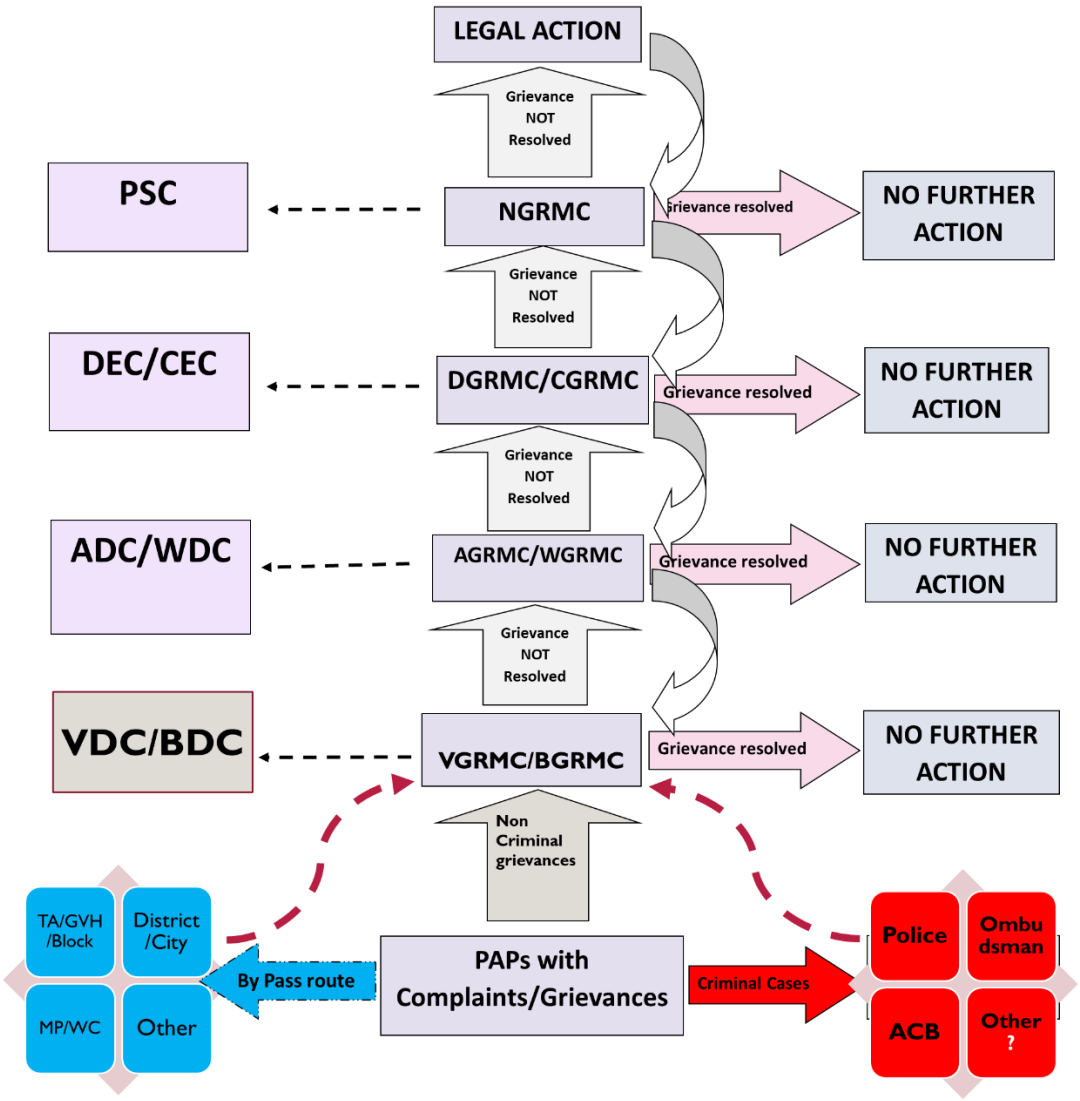

Figure 1: Institutional Arrangement for the SSRLP Grievance Redress Mechanism

7.2 Grievance Redress Procedure

1. *Sub-project Committee Level*. For interventions having subproject implementation committees, the GRM for the SSRLP provides for negotiation and agreement by consensus between the community subproject implementation committee and affected persons as the first avenue to resolve grievances expressed by the people affected by the project. The project in collaboration with District Councils and their extension staff shall orient all the subproject implementation committees on the GRM. The committee at this level shall record, vet and hear cases as submitted to them by PAPs. If the PAP will be satisfied with the resolution, the case will be closed. If not, the case shall be referred to the village grievance redress and management committee (VGRMC).

2. *Village Level*. At this level, the Village Grievance Redress and Management Committee (VGRMC) shall record, vet and hear cases as submitted to them by PAPs as well as referrals from the subproject implementation committees. If the PAP will be satisfied with the resolution, the case will be closed. The Village Development Committee will be appraised on the resolution made by the VGRMC. Membership of the VGRMC will include Youth representative, elected PAPs representative (SCT, EPWP, Livelihoods), Community Based Organization /Faith Based Organization representative, women representative from groups/committees, chairperson of the VDC as an ex-officio member, representative of the community social support committee, and member of the area land management committee.

3. *Area or Traditional Authority (TA) Level.* If cases at the VGRMC are not closed, the grievances shall be referred to the Area Grievance Redress Management Committee (AGRMC). The PAP shall be communicated that his/her issue was referred to the upper committee for hearing. The AGRMC shall receive and record the cases as referred to them by VGRMC. This committee shall hear the case from the PAP and review the decision made by VGRMC. If the PAP will be satisfied with the decision, the case will be closed. The ADC will be appraised on the decision made by the AGRMC. Membership of the AGRMC shall include chairperson of VGRMC specific to the area where grievance has come from, Faith Based Organization representative, women representative (from groups or committees), NGO representative doing related work and working in that particular TA, Chairperson of Area Executive Committee (AEC), Chairperson of Area Development Committee (ADC), Lands clerk and Chairperson of the Youth Network of the area.

4. *District Level.* In the event that the case was not closed at AGRMC, the case will be referred to the District Grievance Redress and Management Committee. The DGRMC shall invite the affected person to hear the case and also review the decisions made earlier by the two lower committees. If the PAP shall accept the resolution made, the case shall therefore be closed at this level. The ADC will be appraised on the outcome of the hearing by AGRMC. Membership of the DGRMC will include the Director of Planning and Development (DPD), District Gender Officer, District Social Welfare Officer, District Labour

Officer, Director of Administration (DoA), District Community Development Officer (DCDO), District Labour Officer (DLO), Judiciary Representative, Victim Support Unit Representative, District NGO Network Representative, and Technical Specialist to be co-opted depending on the issue.

5. *City/ Urban Level*
Under the urban setup, the Village level corresponds to Block/Neighbourhood Level while the Area Level Corresponds to the Ward Level and the District Level to the City Council level. The corresponding GRMC committees will therefore be BGRMC, WGRMC and CGRMC.

6. *National Level.* In the event that the case was not closed at DGRMC, the case will be referred to the NGRMC. The NGRMC shall invite the affected person to hear the case and also review the decisions made earlier by the three lower committees. Where need be, the NGRMC shall liaise with Project Steering Committee (PSC) so that a resolution should be made for the case at hand. If the PAP shall accept the resolution made, the case shall therefore be closed at this level. Membership of the NGRMC will include representatives of the key collaborating institutions of the SSRLP.

7. *Court Option.* Where the case was not closed at national level, the PAP shall be advised to seek justice from the Court of Law and the decision made by the Court of Law shall be final

8. *Criminal and Other Special Cases.* All cases recorded by the GRM that are found to be criminal in nature shall immediately be reported to the police. Communities will also be sensitized to report criminal cases directly to the police. Furthermore, the project will sensitise communities to make use of the existing Tipp-offs anonymous facility established under MASAF IV program to report suspected cases of fraud to the Anti-Corruption Bureau. The contact details of the facility are as follows:

   Ground Telephone (MTL): Dial 80000 847
   Cell Phone (TNM/Airtel): Dial 847
   E-mail: reportssqm@tip-offs.com
   Postal Address: Box 1726, Blantyre

9. *Gender Based Violence Cases*
Since Gender Based Violence (GBV) and Sexual Exploitation and Abuse cases are substantively different from other complaints that are typically handled through the grievance redress mechanisms, their information will be handled in a special way within the GRM to ensure that the information is confidential. The GRM committees will be oriented on how to approach survivors and make referrals of such PAPs to a safe and ethical GBV service provider in the area.

Options for handling GBV/SEA cases shall include:

- A criminal case can be instigated or the PAP can report directly to community based victim support unit, police victim support unit or One Stop Centre.

- If reported to a committee member, the case should be referred to a community based victim support unit, police victim support unit or One Stop Centre
- Other referral points are health centres, child protection extension or community development assistant (CDA).
- Reporting can also be done through other GBV and child protection platforms (like the national toll free line 116).

Principles to be followed when handling GBV/SEA cases include:

- The victim should be treated with respect and dignity and should be given adequate referral information.
- With the victim's consent, the committee member can accompany the PAP to the referral point.
- The victim should be assured of confidentiality and the name of the victim should not be recorded on the GRM Form. However, if given consent the committee member will collect all the information on the perpetrator for redress

7.3 Key Activities in the Grievance Redress Process

The GRM process for SSRLP will consist of five key activities which will be performed in managing the grievances for the project. These key activities include:

(i) Complaint uptake
(ii) Complaint assessment, analysis and response
(iii) Resolution and closure
(iv) Registry and monitoring
(v) GRM Evaluation.

7.3.1 Complaints Uptake

The SSRLP GRM has provided multiple options for submission of grievances by project affected persons in order to minimize barriers that may prevent other PAPs from forwarding their issues. These channels include the following:

(a) Face to Face: This may be verbal or written submissions through face to face interactions with members of committees, programme officials, local structures (chiefs, councilors, MPs) done at any time.

(b) Grievance Box: Grievance boxes will be placed in strategic places of target project communities where PAPs would drop in their grievances at any time. These will also be made available at pay-points when payments are being delivered.

(*c) Toll Freeline*: The existing government call centre which was established and used under the Covid-19 Urban Cash Intervention (CUCI) will be scaled up for use in all components under the SSRLP. PAPs dial **351** to report the grievances to the national call centre for free.

(d) Phone Call or SMS: This will be at PAPs own discretion and capability. Where possible, details of relevant immediate contact persons in the project area will be made available.

7.3.2 Case Assessment, Analysis and Response

When a complaint is received, a maximum of fifteen Days (**15)** days has been provided for the VGRMC to respond to the PAP. This is so to make sure that grievances/complaints are resolved as early as possible. Where possible, provision of instant feedback will be done depending on the nature of the cases.

Once complaints are received, the GRM committees shall assess the issues by looking at, among other factors, the following:

- Whether the complaint or grievance is related to the project or not,
- Whether the case can ably be handled at their level or another,
- Whether the case can effectively be handled through the project GRM or alternative mechanisms.

If for whatever reason the committee determines that it cannot ably handle the complaint, PAPs shall be advised to channel their complaints to the right alternative grievance redress levels or institutions. Otherwise, it will proceed to hear the cases and make necessary investigations to establish the truth of the matter.

7.3.3 Case Resolution and Closure

Where a resolution has been arrived at and the PAP accepts the resolution, the PAP shall be required to sign the resolution and closure section in the Grievance Log and Resolution Form as attached in Annex 1. Two members of the VGRMC (preferably Chairperson and Secretary) shall also be required to counter sign. This shall signify that the complaint or grievance which was presented has been fully discussed and closed.

7.3.4 GRM Registry and Reporting

All grievances received will be publicly entered into an accessible recording system known as the GRM registry that shall be maintained at all the GRM committee levels. The Village log and resolution form shall be in triplicate. For any case heard, closed or referred, a copy of this case shall be sent to the two upper levels for records, i.e. the AGRMC and the DGRMC. Similarly, if a case is handled at AGRMC, a copy shall be sent to District Grievance Redress Mechanism Committee (DGRMC) and another to VGRMC to notify them how the referred case was handled. This shall enable the district to keep a register (Annex 2), of all cases recorded and handled by any GRM committee in their district. Using this information, councils will be able to generate a matrix of cases and agreed resolutions and be able to follow up if the resolutions are being implemented.

7.3.5 GRM Monitoring and Evaluation

The SSRLP GRM monitoring and evaluation will be undertaken alongside any other evaluation exercises for the project. This will be possible using copies of registers that Councils and GRM committees will be keeping. This will assist to establish the levels of functionality and identify areas for improvements to achieve optimum efficiency of the GRM system.

8. SEP MONITORING AND REPORTING

8.1 Monitoring Approach

The NGLF recognizes the importance of monitoring and reporting as it ensures that stakeholder engagement activities are executed as per plan, and where gaps are identified, corrective measures are put in place. Reporting will also enable key stakeholders to be in the know of how the project is faring on implementation of the SEP. Responsible personnel will track progress of SEP activities by undertaking the following throughout the life cycle of the project:

- Reviewing and updating the list of stakeholders on a continuous basis as any new stakeholders that emerge need to be taken into account;
- Documentation of consultations or engagement activities carried out, including issues discussed and views or concerns of participants;
- Grievance redress mechanism (GRM), as an integral part of the process, will be enhanced and an update of grievances recorded, resolved, outstanding and plan to resolve outstanding ones will be prepared;
    - Every GRM committee will maintain a grievance log book/ register, and the list of grievances will be consolidated at district and then national level.
- Minutes of meetings undertaken as part of SEP will be prepared and shared with key stakeholders;
- List of participants to these activities will also be kept;
- Records in forms of photos, videos and list of participants will also be documented.

8.2 Monitoring Responsibility

The monitoring process will be done by both the district officers and central level officers. At district level the District Monitoring and Evaluation Committee (DMEC), headed by the Monitoring Officer, will be in-charge of project monitoring. They will be supported by the DSSC, various project secretariat staff, the district extension workers and community social support committees.

District level monitoring and evaluation unit will be linked to main project monitoring and evaluation unit which will be based within the National Local Government Finance Committee (NLGFC). As indicated earlier on, this unit will also lead the monitoring and reporting on the SEP.

Where relevant immediate feedback will be needed as result of stakeholder consultations, it will be provided through regular correspondence channels to concerned stakeholders. However, Feedback on how comments were incorporated into the project document will be provided through project implementation inception meetings once the project is approved by the bank. Further feedback on issues raised during project implementation will also be provided through the quarterly and annual progress review meetings.

8.3 SEP Performance Monitoring Indicators

The key indicator which will be used to assess the performance of the SEP is the percentage of grievances reported and resolved. This has been included in the results framework of the

project. Other process indicators will include number inception meetings, number of project and program review meetings, number of coordination meetings, number of community interface meetings, number of radio programs aired and number of GRM committees created.

8.4 Reporting

Key indicators of SEP will form part of the entire monitoring and evaluation system of the SSRLP, and internally monthly reports will be generated accordingly. These reports will feed into the Quarterly Progress Reports that will be submitted to World Bank as part of the reporting requirements.

ANNEXES

ANNEX 1: COMMUNITY GRIEVANCE LOG & RESOLUTION FORM

Boma La Dziko La Malawi

Harmonised Grievance Redress Mechanism for Social Support Programmes

Bukhu Lolembamo Madandaulo La Komiti ya Kumudzi

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Unduna wa Zachuma
Nthambi yoona Zitukuko Zochepetsa Komanso Kuteteza Anthu ku Umphawi
P.O. Box 30136
Capital City, Lilongwe 3
Telephone: +265 1 788 888
Telefax: +265 1 788 093/247
Telex: 44648
Email: epd@Malawi.net, mepd@globemw.net

FOMU YOLEMBAPO MADANDAULO YA KOMITI YA KUMUDZI

GAWO LOYAMBA: ZOYAMBILIRA KUDZIWA	***Nambala ya fomu:***

BOMA LA: _____	*TA:* _____	*GVH:* _____
Dzina la polojekiti, gulu kapena kalasita	**Dzina la Mudzi**	**Tsiku la ripoti**
:_____	_____	....

Dzina la odandaula	**Pologalamu ya odandaula**			**Nambala ya foni:**	**Chizindikilo (ID) cha Khomo**
	SCTP	*COMSIP/VSL*	*EPWP*	EMail:.....	
		Palibe			

GAWO LACHIWIRI: ZOFOTOKOZERA DANDAULO

Pologalamu yodandaulidwa	SCTP	EPWP	COMSIP /VSL	Ena:.....	Ndilatsopano (N) kapena Iachokera kwina (K)?	N	K

Ref No.	Tsiku dandaulo laperekedwa	Tsiku lomwe dandaulo lafufuzidwa	Yemwe anatumidwa kufufuza

Tsatanetstane wa dandaulo mwa chidule	Chigamulo chomwe chaperekedwa

Dzina la yemwe wapereka dandaulo:.....

GAWO LA CHITATU: UMBONI OSONYEZA MAPETO A DANDAULO	**GAWO LACHINAYI: KUTUMIZA DANDAULO KWINA**
Ngati dandaulo lafika kumapeto, odandaula komanso wa komiti akuyenera kutsimikizira posayina mmunsimu	Latumizidwa kwa: / Ref No:
Mkulu wa Komiti ya madandaulo:_____	Tsiku lotumiza ...../...../.....
Dzina komanso kusayina kwa Odandaula:.....	Yemwe watumidwa kulondoleza:
Dzina:..... Sig:.....	Ndemanga:
Mlembi wa Komiti ya madandaulo:_____	
Tsiku: _____	

GAWO LACHISANU : UMBONI OSONYEZA KUTI DANDAULO LINAPEREKEDWA

Dandaulo :					Nambala ya fomu:.....
Nambala (ID) ya khomo:	TA:		Zili pati?		Nambala zafoni zaulere zolondolezera dandaulo
GVH:	Pologalamu:		Athana nalo	Latumizidwa Kwina	1
Dzina la Odandaula:			Dzina:.....		2
Sayini ya odandaula:.....		Olandila dandaulo	Sayini:.....		Tsiku:...../...../.....

ANNEX 2: AREA GRM LOGBOOK

Government of the Republic of Malawi

Harmonised Grievance Redress Mechanism for Social Support Programmes

Grievance Logbook for Area Level Committee

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Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs
Poverty Reduction and Social Protection Division
P.O. BOX 30136
Capital City
Lilongwe 3
Telephone: +265 1 788 888
Telefax: +265 1 788 093/247
Telex: 44648
Email: epd@Malawi.net, mepd@globemw.net

AREA LEVEL GRIEVANCE LOG AND RESOLUTION FORM								
SECTION A: GENERAL INFORMATION							***Form Number:***	
*District Name:*_____				*TA:*_____			*GVH:*_____	
Name of Project Location/ Village Cluster:				**Name of Community/ Village:**			**Reporting Dates:**	
:_____							……	……	……
Name of Complainant		**Complainant Program:**			**Phone Number:**		**Household ID:**	
		SCTP	*COMSIP/VSL*	*EPWP*	EMail:……			
			Non-Ben					
SECTION B: DETAILS OF THE GRIEVANCE								
Program complained about:		SCTP	EPWP	COMSIP /VSL	Other:	Is grievance **New** or **Refferal**?	New	Refferal
Ref No.	Date grievance is reported		Follow-up/Investigation date			Person Assigned		
Description of Grievance						Resolution Made		
Name of person reporting the issue:……								
SECTION C: GRIEVANCE CLOSURE						**SECTION D: GRIEVANCE REFERRAL**		
If case is closed, GRM Committee members & complainant to sign below						Referred to:	Ref No:	
GRM Committee Chair:_____						Date of Receiving a Referral:	……/……/……	
Name & Signature of Project Affected Person /Beneficiary:						Person assigned to do follow up:		
Name:……	Sig:……					Remarks:		
GRM Committee Secretary_____								
Date: _____								
SECTION E: GRIEVANCE SUBMISSION RECEIPT								
Complaint :							Form #:……	
Household ID:		TA:				Case Stutus	Toll free lines for follow up	
District:		Program:				Closed / Referred	1	
Name of Complainant:				Reported to (name of officer and signature):		:……	2	
Signature of complainant:						:……	Date:……/……/……	

ANNEX 3 : DISTRICT GRM LOGBOOK

Government of the Republic of Malawi

Harmonised Grievance Redress Mechanism for Social Support Programmes

Grievance Logbook for District Level Committee

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Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs
Poverty Reduction and Social Protection Division
P.O. BOX 30136
Capital City
Lilongwe 3
Telephone: +265 1 788 888
Telefax: +265 1 788 093/247
Telex: 44648
Email: epd@Malawi.net, mepd@globemw.net

DISTRICT GRIEVANCE LOG AND RESOLUTION FORM

												Form Number:
SECTION A: GENERAL INFORMATION												
District Name: _____						*TA:* _____						*GVH:* _____
Name of Project Location/ Village Cluster:						**Name of Community/ Village:**						**Reporting Dates:**
:_____						_____						……. …… …….
Name of Complainant			**Complainant Program:**			**Phone Number:**						**Household ID:**
			SCTP	*COMSIP/VSL*	*EPWP*	EMail:……						
				Non-Ben								
SECTION B: DETAILS OF THE GRIEVANCE												
Program complained about:			SCTP	EPWP	COMSIP /VSL	Other:		Is grievance **New** or **Refferal**?			New	Refferal
Ref No.	Date grievance is reported			Follow-up/Investigation date				Person Assigned				
Description of Grievance								Resolution Made				
Name of person reporting the issue:……												
SECTION C: GRIEVANCE CLOSURE								**SECTION D: GRIEVANCE REFERRAL**				
If case is closed, GRM Committee members & complainant to sign below								Referred to:				Ref No:
GRM Committee Chair:_____								Date of Receiving a Referral				……/……/……
Name & Signature of Project Affected Person /Beneficiary:								Person assigned to do follow up:				
Name:……				Sig:……				Remarks:				
GRM Committee Secretary_____												
Date: _____												
SECTION E: GRIEVANCE SUBMISSION RECEIPT												
Complaint :												**Form #:**……
Household ID:				TA:				Case Stutus				Toll free lines for follow up
District:				Program:				Closed	Referred		1	
Name of Complainant:						Reported to (name of officer and signature):					2	
Signature of complainant:											Date:……/……/……	

ANNEX 4 : DISTRICT GRM REGISTER

Government of the Republic of Malawi

Harmonised Grievance Redress Mechanism for Social Support Programmes

District Grievance Register

Ministry of Economic Planning and Development
Poverty Reduction and Social Protection Division
P.O. Box 30136
Capital City, Lilongwe 3
Telephone: +265 1 788 888
Telefax: +265 1 788 093/247
Telex: 44648
Email: epd@Malawi.net, mepd@globemw.net

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DISTRICT GRIEVANCE REGISTER

Name of the District:…… *District Reference No:……..*

Ref #	***Date 1st reported***	***Household Name***	***Household ID***	***TA***	***Type of Grievance/Complaint:***	***Resolution Made:***	***Program***	***Status (Open, Closed)***

ANNEX 5: SUMMARY OF COMMENTS AND ISSUES FROM FIELD STAKEHOLDER CONSULTATIONS

Target Group	*Issues Raised*	*How the issues have been addressed*
District Environmental Sub-committee & District Social Support Committees	Adequate consultations to be done with the communities.	This has been done and will continues to be done in all target districts
	The number of beneficiaries in this new project should increase.	It is not possible to increase the number of beneficiaries since the project has a limited budget. However the project will lobby with other projects and organizations working in the same areas to reach out to those that may not be targeted under this project.
	There has been poor asset creation in the previous PWP and one cause of this is involvement of ward councillors. Councillors diverted certain projects so they could push their political agenda forward. In this new project, how are we going to handle councillors?	Councillors and councils will be sensitized on their roles in the project
	Department of Nutrition, HIV and AIDS (DNHA) should be included in the list of implementers	DNHA will be actively involved in planning and delivery of relevant programs at district level
	Decentralize disaster assessment process to district councils minimize time wasting which is experienced when the process is controlled from the central level.	Assessments will done by the Councils in collaboration with DODMA
	In the absence of sensitizations on the new methods i.e. electronic payments might bring challenges accessibility of money, need more sensitizations.	To be done extensively
	Worries on workability of electronic payment since most beneficiaries do not have phones and are not literate in the new payment systems like Mpamba.	Sensitizations of beneficiaries will be done. There will be gradual roll out of the system
	SCTP might reduce charcoal burning through the top ups.	Business and financial trainings will be provided
	Fears that the programmes deepens dependency syndrome.	IGA's should be able mitigate dependency syndrome.
	Environmental degradation e.g roads projects	Sub-projects will be screened and ESMPs will be developed accordingly
	Sabotage of activities because of few beneficiaries involved	Civic education will be done in the communities
	Delay in procuring materials	Procurement of materials on PWP will be done by the communities
	No funds for implementation of ESMP's	The project will provide funds for ESMP implementation
	Too many projects per hotspot and resources for safeguards monitoring were not enough.	The project will provide funds for safeguards monitoring
	Enhancement of child labour at household level emanating from the fact that adults are going to be preoccupied with project activities	Sensitization of household beneficiaries on child labour
	Climate change impacts (unpredictable rains, too much rains etc	Promotion of climate smart agriculture in relevant project interventions
	Pollution of water courses due to pesticides use or chemical usage	Sensitization on Integrated Pest Management
	Need for coordination between the different sectors at district level.	Strengthen capacity of DESC and DSSC

Target Group	*Issues Raised*	*How the issues have been addressed*
	Land degradation from charcoal making and other activities that might destroy environment	Alternative business and Investment opportunities will be promoted under livelihood enhancement activities
	Conflicts arising due to land ownership	Subprojects will only be implemented only on sites where land is donated voluntarily and certified through signed voluntary land donation forms
	Late provision of wages on PWP	System will be improved to ensure timely payment. Payments will be made every 2 months E-payment will improve efficiency of payment
	Create employment among the youth (make sure more youths are engaged in the program	Most of the beneficiaries will be the youth
	Crime will be reduced because the youth will be economically empowered.	Most of the beneficiaries will be the youth
	Human trafficking will reduce through skills development and top ups.	Sensitization of communities on Human Trafficking
	Skills transfer (business skills and in other areas). Making the families resilient even in the months when they had no food.	Business and financial trainings will be provided
	Increase in child prostitution because rural areas will be opened up due project activities	communities will be sensitized
	Increase in gender related abuses perpetrated by men as they will have more power over the money being generated by women	communities will be sensitized
	Risk of injury	Protective gear will be provided for those who are working on risky areas
Community		
	UBR system for the new project may omit some old members	UBR system will promote fairness and ensure that only eligible households are enrolled
	PWP timing should not coincide with farming period	Fund transfer accounting and liquidation system will be improved to ensure timely implementation of activities
	People who could not take part in the project felt discriminated (all catchments had fixed number of beneficiaries).	Transparent and reliable targeting criteria will be used following the UBR system which will promote fairness
	Construction of roads during the dry season has been hard for the elderly and the sickly because the work is more energy intensive than is the case during rainy season.	All systems will be improved to ensure implementation of subprojects according to their appropriate times and seasons. The UBR will also ensure that only eligible people (i.e. those with labour capacity) are recruited for EPWP
	There is need for an alternative receiver of payment in the e-payment	Provisions will be made for alternative receivers
	Marriage interference impact due to women participation in the project (women not respecting their husbands)	Sensitization project beneficiaries on gender related issues targeting both men and women
	There is need to prevent double dipping as it brings conflicts within the community.	UBR system will assist t to eliminate double dipping
	Elderly people not benefiting from these good programs feel discriminated	UBR system will ensure that the elderly are considered under appropriate programs
	There is need to understand why other people are not progressing. Hence need to also consider providing support to those individuals who are better off.	Suggestion is noted and will be used in providing customized support to project beneficiaries

Target Group	*Issues Raised*	*How the issues have been addressed*
	Need for first aid kit during PW cycle.	The project will project first aid kits for high risk activities such as construction, farming, sanitation and hygiene activities
	Chiefs are not being involved in the program especially SCT.	Chiefs will be sensitized on their roles before commencement of project activities
	Variations in the amount of money that is provided	Results of case management verifications will be timely communicated
	Beneficiaries should be made aware when the bank/program has reduced the amount or increased the transfer.	Beneficiaries will be well communicated on all payment issues
	Lack of coordination during pay parade between the paying team (bank) and the District team.	The Bank and District team will be sensitized to improve their coordination
	Targeting criteria brought conflicts in the community	Use of the UBR system and Mthandizi MIS is expected to improve the targeting process and eliminate potential causes of conflicts